

Writing goal and principles

With every piece we write for the CleverTap platform, we aim to:

- **Empower:** Help users understand CleverTap using language that informs them and make the most out of it.
- **Respect:** Users are on CleverTap to do a job and complete tasks. Respect that they have other things to do. Don't market at them when working; communicate with them respectfully.
- **Educate:** Tell users what they need to know, not just what we want to say. Don't assume that they may or may not know something. Give them the information they need, and guide them to where they can learn more.
- **Be honest:** Understand the part we play in our user's lives. If you don't have something necessary to say, don't say it. Avoid writing fluff.

To do the above, a few things to keep in mind when writing are the following.

Understand the purpose and message

Be clear about the topic you're writing for. Ask yourself:

- Why am I writing this?
- What is the user's goal?
- What might the user be feeling at the moment?
- What message do I want to communicate?
- What's the outcome and what would I like the user to feel?

Write like a human

- **Keep things simple:** Choose words and phrases that you'd use when talking to a friend. Avoid jargon such as industry-specific terms or names for UI and engineering features.

Tip: Use [The Handy List of Human Words](#) to achieve this.

- **Write for all reading levels:** Use contractions and short sentences of 12-15 words. Writing tip: Use the [Hemingway Editor](#) to achieve this.
- **Write in the present tense:** Use the present tense to describe product behavior. Avoid using the future tense to describe the way the product acts. If necessary to use the past or future tense, use simple verb forms.

Focus on the user

- **Emphasize benefits to the user:** Explain why it's good for them, instead of leading with what "we" are trying to do or give.
- **Begin with the objective:** When a phrase describes a goal or action needed to achieve it, start the sentence with a goal. Example - *"To remove from..., do this..."* not *"Do this..., to remove from."*
- **Use consistent words:** Name and address features across the UI consistently.

Make things scannable

- **Write clear, descriptive headings and titles:** Most people only read headings, use keywords to describe the content, and make sure the most important information is conveyed there.
- **Break up long-paragraphs:** As a general rule, people hate reading, and no one likes a wall of text. Break up what you're writing into small chunks and use bullet points where needed.
- **Use logical grouping:** Understand the sequence of your information and group related concepts logically. Make the content scannable using whitespace, headings, and bullets.
- **Refer to UI elements only by label:** Say "Click Continue," not "Click the Continue button."

Edit ruthlessly

Once you've written a piece, trim it down.

- **Read sentences and phrases out loud:** If it sounds weird or unnatural, change and revise it.
- **Remove extra words and fluff:** If something doesn't need to be said, take it out.
- **Reveal details as needed:** The user doesn't need to know everything in the first interaction. Reveal more details about the features as the user explores them and needs more information.
- **Be consistent:** Follow our common phrases and terms, along with the style and grammar mechanics.